



1. (From left) Raj Chengappa, Group Editorial Director (Publishing), India Today Group with Piyush Goyal **2.** Srikant Datar
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a desire for individuals to stay connected in some way to the work that they're doing... Things will work out over the next few months, and perhaps the next couple of years. But, given this tension, what organisations are trying to think about is, is there some innovative way where you can respond to both? For example, organisations are thinking about anchor days, where you get the ability to have this community but not necessarily everyone shows up in office all five days a week. Even in very desirable jobs, when executives say you have to come for all five days, people are saying no. How do you then create the culture that you can have people coming together and working together, providing this flexibility? How do you make it attractive for individuals? I think there will be many experiments. At the moment everyone is saying, 'Let's try a few different things to see how it will work out'.



There is talk of a four-day work

week. Do you think this is a pipe dream or is it the new reality?

In the US, it's not there yet. But if you're saying four-day work week in office, people would be very happy if that was the conclusion right now. It's still the flexible workday, a trend everyone is trying to work towards. But it could become a four-day work week. Certainly, you're seeing a lot fewer individuals showing up in the office on Mondays and Fridays, but I don't know if you want to call that a four-day work week because people are still expected to work on Mondays and Fridays.



How do you deal with The Great Resignation?

This is a really a 'classic design thinking problem'. How do you understand this tension in terms of flexibility on the one hand and the desire to have community on the other? And how do you design the workplace and the work itself, [and what are] the opportunities for development? That bar has been raised.

Companies will continue to try to innovate, figure out ways in which the development of these individuals is going to be seen as more important.



Do you think that those who come from non-tech backgrounds have a disadvantage? How can they actively upskill themselves?

I think it's a huge mistake if people think that just because I need to have technical skills, people are not important anymore. One must always think about technology and people as two sides of a coin. The more you build technology, the more you have to think about what is the impact that's going to have on people. For me, much of that learning and understanding came from Mahatma Gandhi... my father was part of the freedom struggle and a follower of Gandhiji. So we learnt Gandhiji's seven deadly sins... as a very important lesson to absorb. And so even as I think about some of the things that we're talking about, imagine what this would do: sci-